Volume VI

February 1988

Number #fifty-two

Villager Tower





Presbyterian Church - church by the River

Why The interest? Why the sudden talk of restoration? History; that which is an integral part of our existence. Without the past, we would not advance. Without the former historical residents, we would be lost. If it weren't for our ancestors we wouldn't possess the quaint, charming village we now have. It takes special vision to see the potential in ancient structures bursting with tales of days gone by. And we need those individuals who wish to unfold those memories and bring them to light.

Not so long ago, the Presbyterian Church was the headquarters for interpretive programs. Tours were given, starting in the building, referred to as the "The Church By The River", built in 1913. The exterior is breathtaking in itself, should you allow the aura to touch you. In days past, a community was not complete without spiritual enhancement, as well. The churches in communities completed the bond of men in early days. *1

The Church by The River was of conventional design probably from a design book. The Gothic character is combined with hints of the Queen Ann Revival style. The Queen Ann Revival details illustrate the stylistic lag characterizing much of Carver's architecture. *2

"Carver's importance today is not that it possesses any exceptional architectural gems. Rather, the city is significant when taken as a whole - as a tapestry of simple stitches. Carver with its picturesque setting and its large collection of surviving 19th century buildings, deserves to be preserved.

"The restoration efforts of numerous individuals and organizations are laudable. But the 20th century is taking its toll. Many of Carver's buildings have already been lost through remodeling or demolition. If this already frayed fabric which is Carver is allowed to ravel any further, the unique townscape will disappear, and the remaining building will not reflect our history." *2

With the loss of each historical page of the past it's very much like a fire swallowing and engulfing its victim; never to be shared by sight, felt by walking its confines or seen physically and lost to the future. A loss never able to be recaptured.

Look for continued historical facts in the next issue of the **Villager Tower.**

*1 Carver-On-The-Minnesota > Advertisement Flyer
*2 "Carver Historical District Design One: Architecture"



Carver-on-the-Minnesota

Revival of the Carver-On-The-Minnesota non-profit organization was the topic of major discussion on February 11th, 1988 at the Carver Antique House. Many braved the subzero temperatures to generate interest in the history of this city.

Jeff Siegle presented a brief history of the formulation of this organization by Edie Hermann, Ann Doerr, Mary Lee Dayton and others. The organization was incorporated in 1969. The holdings of the original members are still assets to the organization. Preservation of history and continued interest are still the primary motivation.

Two board members at present are issuing invitations and encouragement to form a new board and recruit members to renew interest and revive Carver-On-The-Minnesota Discussion of reactivating the Heritage Committee was also discussed.

Motivation towards restoration of the Presbyterian Church and an active role in SteamBoat Days were the top priorities of the organization at present.

On March 10th at the Carver Antique House, another meeting will be taking place. General membership dues free/Interested or questions? Contact George Piper [448-2860] or contact the **Villager Tower** [Ricki Schultz 448-5126]. There are not any obligations. Come and check it out. You won't know if you are interested, unless you come and see what the whole thing is about. Without Community support, we could lose another valuable piece of history.

With the revival of the Carver-On-The-Minnesota, we can also look forward to another expansion of the **Villager Tower** and learn what still another organization is doing in and for **our** community.

Remember -- March 10th at 7:00 PM - Carver Antique House - Can you afford to miss it?

Lioness News

Councilman Hanson representing the committee involving restoration and maintenance of the Presbyterian Church and the vacant lot on Braodway, if acquisition by the city were to occur was discussed with the Lioness at their January meeting. The properties are now assets of the Carver-On-The-Minnesota organization. One stipulation with the acquisition is that the historic features must be retained. The building has some structural damage, in need of heating, among a variety of other items. There has been discussion of the use of the church as a city facility and civic organization usage. Estimates for repair are being sought at present. Local discussion has been generated for ideas of usage, ways to finance restoration project and to retain its historical value. There was more interest expressed in the development of a park on the vacant lot. Acquisition of one asset without the other was not absolute.

Lioness Christmas party was a success and everyone had fun.

The annual Bullhead Feed and Vegas Night was discussed. This event was scheduled for March 18th, serving from 4:00 to 8:00.

Orville Tretlin, representative of the Youth Exchange Program sent notice of wishing to speak to the group. This topic is scheduled for the future.

Attendance was discussed. If members are not active, the organization will not be effective. Discussion was held on this. Methods to improve attendance was decided and then see if this problem could be solved.

SteamBoat Days special meeting should be held to discuss the annual event.

Submitted by a Carver Lioness:

"Compliments to the City of Carver from a car that passes through daily on the way to work. 'The streets of Carver are so clean and free of snow."

Carver Lioness meet the second Monday of each month at 7:00 PM at the Carver Village Hall. People wishing to join are urged to attend. An example of the Lioness community service is the presentation of the new Christmas decorations in the City of Carver.

Thanks to the Carver Lionesses!



City Council News



Phone Bill

The Fire Department's phone bill was discussed at the February 1st meeting. The sounding of the civil defense siren is the cause for the high phone bill. Mayor Meyers would check into radio equipment sounding alarm, in order to eliminate this cost.

Ordinance



Several questions were raised on February 1st regarding future hook-up charges. For example; originally connections from the main to the tank were included by the grant. However, as proposed in the new ordinance, these costs become the property owners responsibility. These charges could be too expensive for owners, it was concluded. Motion was made and carried with all ayes to hold a Public Hearing on the ordinance at the April meeting. Reviewal of the ordinance will take place at the March meeting.



Bonds

Carolyn Drude [Ehlers and Associates] was present on February 1st to discuss payment of short term water bonds. She recommended non-payment until the call date of October 1st, 1988. She informed the council that the water fund was close to estimated amounts before the start of the project. But, grant money is still tied up in the project. Issuance of long term bonds should wait until October.

Ordinance involving new hook-up and connections was questioned. Ms. Drude stated that future hook-ups were not needed for the principal and interest on the bonds. These connections should be used for operation and maintenance of the system.



Basketball

Complaint was expressed on February 1st regarding the Village Hall by the Fire Department. Clean up was required before the organization could use the hall. Damage had also been incurred. Discussion was held concerning payment for damage and the development of rules for players. consensus of the council was to deny the use of the hall by players until they have met with the council.



CDBG Update

Knudson, HRA Executive Director told the council on February 1st that the structure in the floodway would involve extensive work, in order to utilize it for storage. Surveys and paper work were requried. Demolition of the house was the consensus of the council.

Disconnection of the gas line to the structure was discussed. Knuson requested permission to have this line cut. Council was in agreement.

Council was told that the SCDP [Samll Communities Development Program] grant had been monitored by the Minnesota Department of Trade and Economic Development [DTED] and questions were raised regarding assessement abatement. Since these are policy decisions, they should be addressed by the council. Knudson recommended that abatement assessments be amended, submitted to DTED, a public hearing held and abatement process reopended. Only individual eligible in 1986, but who did not apply would be eligible now, even if they wouldn't qualify now. Motion was made and carried with all ayes authorizing Knudson to proceed with amending the assessment abatement program. Councilman Briggs suggested that DTED be contracted to obtain their guidance.

Payment request was submitted, approved by motion and carried with all ayes.

Knudson discussed the problem of HRA's cash flow since the council is only meeting once per month. Solution was discussed. Motion was made and carred with all ayes authorizing signature for HRA payments, prior to meetings and hold funds for council approval.

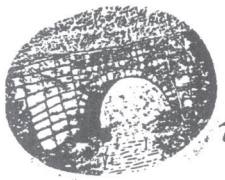
Munitech, Inc.



Munitech's representative, Bob Polston reported on February first that the pond aerators are designed to operate under a dome of ice. The manufacturer stated that chipping ice away should not be done because damage could result.

Chlorine level was down and continuing to remain in acceptable range, the council was told. Rocks in the water system were asked about. The Fire Department has not pumped since January. Relief valve has not been received either.





Carver-on-the-Minnesota

Carver Antiques House owner, George Piper told the council on February 1st about the organizations' revival plans. City Administrator Spiotta was requested to attend the scheduled meeting for the Carver-On-The-Minnesota organization.



Parking Zone

Time Limited Parking Zone resolution on Lime Street was approved by roll vote of all ayes. Same parking resolution for Fifth Street was also approved by roll call vote of all ayes.

Planning Commission

Planning Commission terms for two representatives expires the first of February; Rosamond Dols and Mike Orvick.

One member has agreed to continue serving on the board. Motion was made and carried with all ayes reappointing the two individuals to another two year term. Discussion was held regarding the issue of one member deciding not to accept. Another representative would have to be appointed, if this were the case.

Insurance

Use of fire station to work on vehicles was addressed on February first. Questions were answered by the insurance company. Fireman are covered under General Liability coverage. Precautions should be taken and consultation with the insurance company's Loss Control personnel should be done.

City Administrator told the council of comparisons made regarding B & D Catering and the Lion's insurance. B & D Catering should be covered by the Lion's Club insurance when cooking for the Lion's Club.



Mountain Lion

Several residents presented complaints on February 1st regarding a mountain lion in the city limits. Deputies had checked into the situation. Since there is not any ordinance pertaining to said animal, no action could be taken. Animal was examined by a veterinarian. City Administrator Spiotta was directed to talk to the owner and seek a solution to the problem.



Gilfillan Avenue

Plowing and sanding has been a problem because of the steep grade on Gilfillan Avenue. Question still exists whether or not this is a city street. City Administrator hass ben researching the issue. If this is not a dedicated street, owners will be notified and city m aintenance will be discontinued.

Discussion was held on maintenance of other undedicated streets, emphasis placed on snow removal. Aid has been given when there has been a heavy snowfall. Aid was acceptable, but all undedicated streets should be treated alike.

Black Sox



Request was made for the use of the Village Hall for the Black Sox and a license. Discussion was held regarding questions of an event where women were excluded in a public building. Approval by the council for this type of event warranted a discrimination suit. Representative commented that women had never been turned away, they usually didn't attend. Suggestion was made to change the name of 'Stag Party'. Motion previously made was withdrawn. Second motion was made and carried with four ayes and one nay to approve temporary license for the Black Sox Fund Raiser on March 19th, 1988.

Tentative Agenda

Submitted by the City of Carver

March 7, 1988 - Monday Evening
Council Meeting - 6:30 PM

1) Call to Order
2) Approve Minutes
3) Approve Claims
4) Petitions from Residents
5) Public Works Report
6) Maier Stewart
7) Munitech's Report
8) City Administrator's Report
9) Other Business
10) Adjourn

Disclaimer

The preliminary unapproved minutes from the City of Carver's council meetings were referenced to compose the **Villager Tower.**



Miscellaneous

Deputies from the Carver County Sheriff's Department were present on February 1st. Mayor inquired whether or not the dog issue had been resolved. Vicious dogs will be disposed of and taken in for examination. Nuisance dogswill be returned to owners, if known. Complaints regarding unknown dogs will be handled.

Fire Chief Riesgraf presented rural contract agreements with Dahlgren and San Fransciso Townships. Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving rural contracts. Discussion occurred pertaining to request directed to attempt getting unit costs closer for townships and city residents.

NSP has installed street lights requested by the city.

Motion was made and carried with all ayes approving license for the Lioness Club's Bullhead Feed scheduled March 18th.

Participation in Cities Week sponsored by the League of Minnesota Cities was inquired about. City Administrator would make presentation at the next meeting.

Dick Larson contacted the city regarding the antique show during SteamBoat Days. Several organizations will be consulted regarding the annual event.

Councilman Briggs stated that the sanitation license fee survey shows that the increase imposed was competitive with neighboring cities. Mayor wishes to review resolution on streets, in order for large trucks to conduct business within the city.

Boy Scout had forwarded a letter requesting permission to coordinate a playground area in the Lion's Park. City Administrator was directed to contact the young man about possibly doing the new city park versus the Lion's Park.

City Administrator was directed to contact Hydro Engineering regarding check valves still not operating properly.

Notice

The City of Carver's regular Planning commission meetings have been held on the last Wednesday of each month. Starting with the February, 1988 meeting, this will be changed to the last Thursday of each month at 7:00 PM.

City Clerk
Patricia Plekkenpol
City of Carver



Trivia Questions

1) What country is due north of Chad?
2) Whose father ran the Gilli's Grocery Store?
3) Who figured out how to win friends and influence people?
4) What's the wind-blown plant called the 'Russion Thistle' better known as?
5) What spicy spiker of Bloody Mary is bottled in New Iberia, Louisiana?
6) Who do Eben and Sara Kent raise?
7) How is the year 1010 written in Roman numerals?
8) What month does Munich's Oktoberfest begin?
9) Who wrote the teme to Peter Gunn?
10) How many of every four karate students in the US is a woman?
11) Does Mona Lisa wear a necklace?
12) What company brews Michelob beer?



BullHead Feed and Vegas Night



Sponsored By: Carver Lioness
Date : March 18, 1988
Time : Serving 4:00 PM to 8:00 PM



In Case of an Emergency

Water and Sewer Emergencies:

Munitech has 24 Hours a day answering:

472-2718

Or Call:

Pat - 448-5353

Or:

Ken - 448-5353

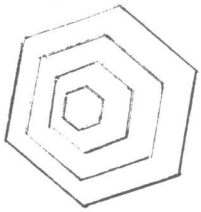
Carver Fire Department Highlights

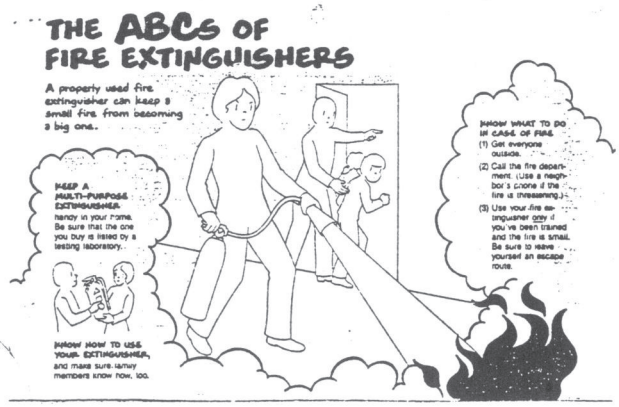


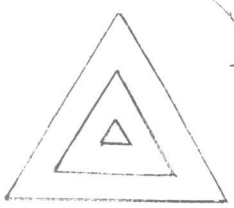
Submitted by the Carver Fire Department

March 1988

March 3rd	Drill Night	6:30 PM
March 17th	St Patrick's Day	
March 20th	First Day of Spring	
March 21st	Drill Night	6:30 PM
March 27th	Palm Sunday	
March 31st	Meeting Night	8:00 PM







Another exciting assignment!

Staff

Ricki Yvonne Schultz
Lucie Hartley!
John W. Schultz and Company
Annette - Kimberly - Richard
Joycelyn L. Reus
Cheryl Joiner!

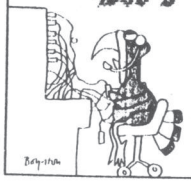


Sponsors

Harvey's Bar

TELEPHONE MESSAGE

High but Dry Balloons
Bob's Berry Farm
Carver Cafe



That line is still busy. Will you hold till Monday?"

Munitech, Inc.

Trivia Answers

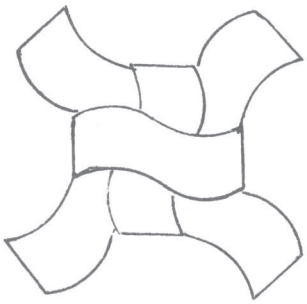


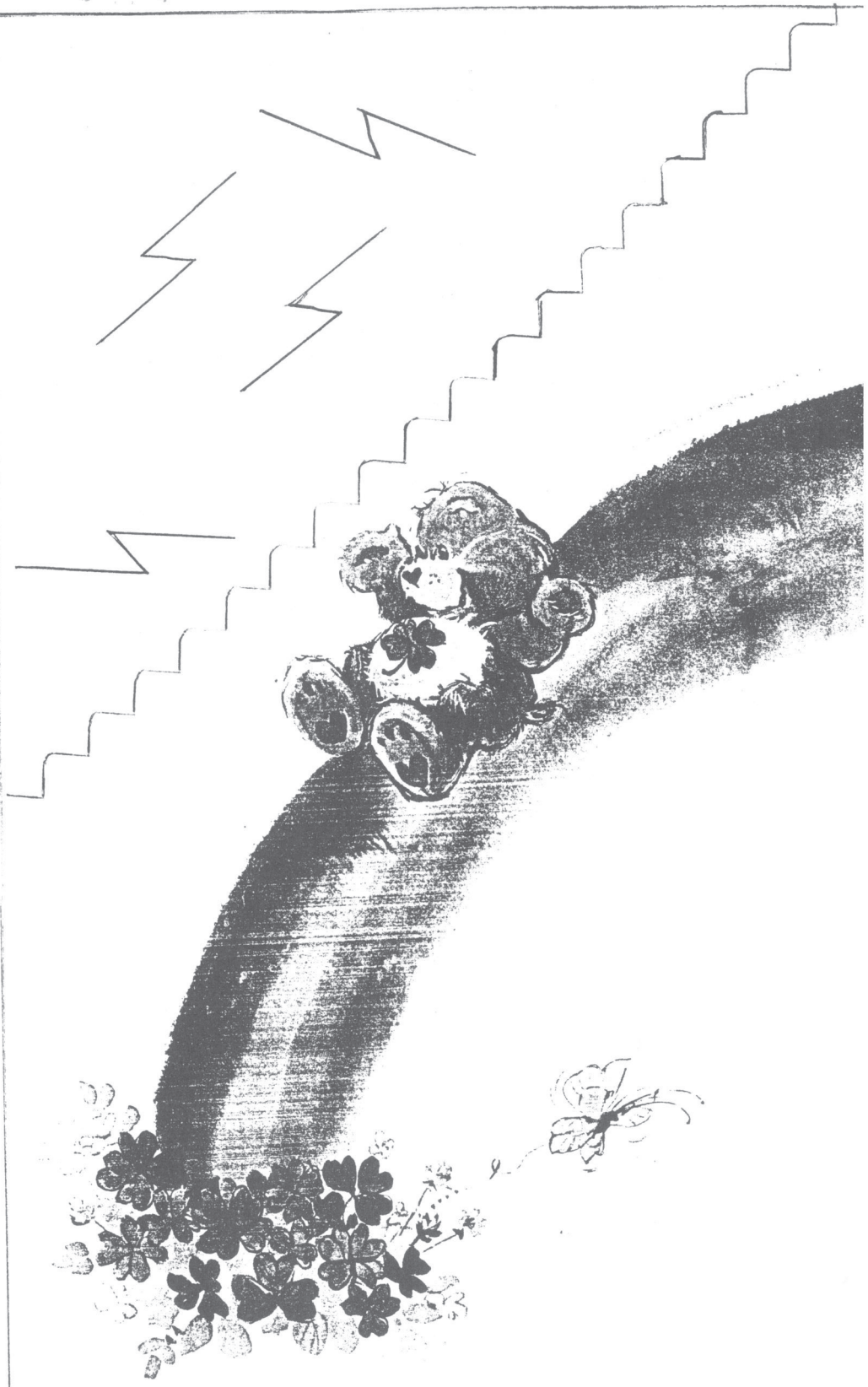
1) Libya
2) Dobie Gillis's
3) Dale Carnegie
4) Tumbleweed
5) Tabasco
6) Clark Kent or Superboy
7) MX
8) September
9) Henry Nanciní
10) One
11) No
12) Anheuser-Busch

Villager Tower

In case you hadn't noticed, we had a name change in 1988 for the newsletter, formerly known as the **"Carver Gazette"**. For our sixth year of production, we will be known as the **"Villager Tower"**. The name was derived to highlight the wooden water tower that encompasses the residents and at the same time retain some history in black and white. The picture was created and drawn by Joycelyn Reus.







Good ♥ Luck ♥ Bear ♥ Wants ♥ Everyone ♥ To Join ♥ Together ♥ and ♥ Think ♥ Spring ♥♥♥♥♥